About the Book

8 NOVEMBER 2016 WAS A BLACK SWAN EVENT IN INDIAN HISTORY.

At one stroke, 86 per cent of the currency in circulation was demonetized, causing confusion, chaos and endless misery to the common Indian. While the Modi government claimed that it was the silver bullet that India needed to eliminate many of its long-standing problems, such as black money, corruption, tax evasion and terror funding, the months that followed proved it otherwise.

The return of 99.7 per cent of the banned 500-rupee and 1,000-rupee notes showed that the idea of a Demonetization Dividend was nothing but a mirage. As a result of demonetization, livelihoods of millions in the informal sector were destroyed, causing enormous distress to farmers and traders and forcing many micro, small and medium businesses into bankruptcy. Economic growth slid to as low as 5.6 per cent in the quarter through June 2017. In fact, all claims by the government fell flat.

One of India's most respected bankers, Meera H. Sanyal provides a comprehensive analysis of the policy, its execution and its pitfalls. The Big Reverse presents unprecedented insights backed by data, history and research. And answers the questions that still continue to haunt Indians on the what, why and how of demonetization.